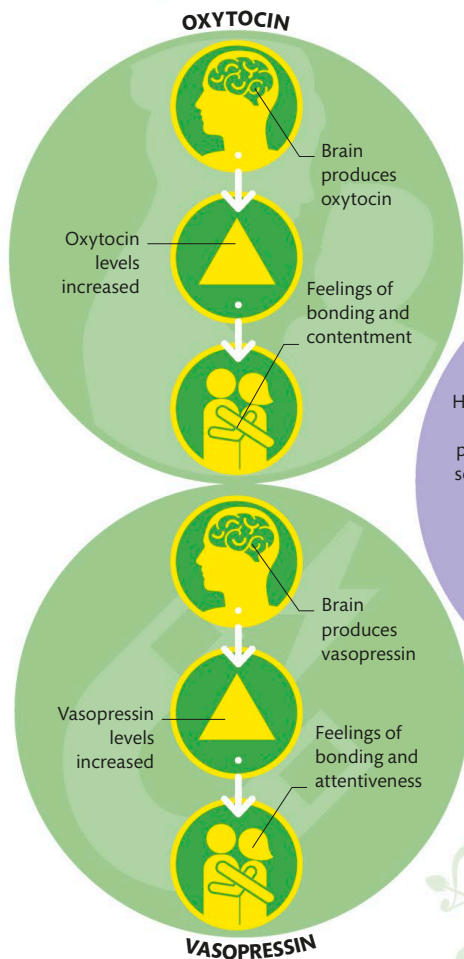
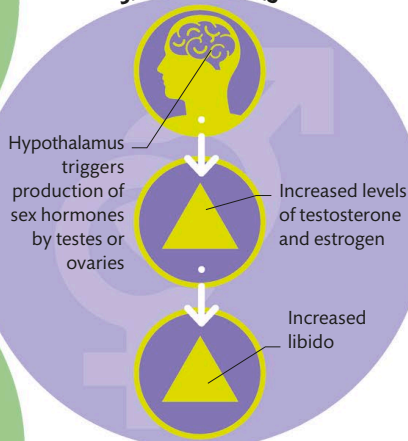




OXYTOCIN REDUCES ACTIVITY IN THE BRAIN'S FEAR CENTER



SEX HORMONES



Attachment

The hormones oxytocin and vasopressin have multiple effects—including making us feel more protective of our object of attraction and attentive to their needs. They stimulate long-term bond formation but can increase distrust of others.

Lust

Lust is the primeval urge to engage in sexual relationships, driven by the sex hormones testosterone and estrogen. While they increase libido in men and women respectively, they alone do not induce lasting connections.

Facial symmetry

A person's face is key to how attractive others find them. Humans and monkeys prefer symmetrical faces—symmetry is an indicator of good health and genetics. Many species also favor sexually dimorphic faces, males preferring feminine faces and vice versa. These factors interact: higher facial symmetry increases a face's perceived femininity or masculinity.

KEY

- Symmetrical face
- Asymmetrical face

FEMALE

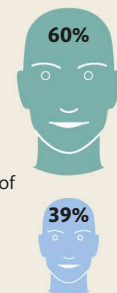


MALE



European

When shown composite faces with high or low symmetry, European observers judged high-symmetry faces to appear more feminine or masculine.



Hadza

Similar results were found in the Hadza people, an indigenous Tanzanian ethnic group. This suggests that the link between symmetry and attractiveness is universal.